Livestock: eggs first, then goats

How to start the animals that give the galley its eggs and, later, goats to sell: what to keep and why, the houses with their sizes, the daily care and the rules.

Status: guide of 2026-10-28. No animal arrives before the checks below; house sites wait for the 200 m lake measurement.

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What to keep, and when

Animal	Decision	Why
Laying hens	Start first, about 100 hens	Eggs every day for the galley; outside the Rift Valley fever quarantine; insurable; laying from about 20 weeks [V LVS-67, MKT-21]
Goats	Later, 2 to 4 local does	The 0.32 ha paddock feeds 2 to 4 does [E]; wait until the district vet confirms the Rift Valley fever and movement status in writing [V LVS-03, LVS-29]
Broilers	Only for the kitchen, if at all	Farm-gate prices in 2025 were below the cost of raising them [V LVS-72]
Pigs	Not now	African swine fever: pig trade and movement banned in Bugesera since 2026-04-10, not lifted [V REG-22]
Rabbits	A small trial at most	No vaccination programme found; not insured [V MKT-21]

Before any animal arrives

1. **Register as a keeper** under the new animal law, in force since its publication on 2026-09-11: keepers register, only a vet treats animals, and every move needs a movement certificate [V REG-24].
2. **Measure the distances:** every animal house at least 200 m from the lake's furthest flood line and 20 m from any swamp; a breach costs RWF 500,000 and demolition [V LOC-01, LOC-02].
3. **Name a vet:** the sector or district veterinary officer, or a private vet from the mandated companies [V LOC-48].
4. **Fence and water first:** the paddock fence, a water point at each house, shade trees at the paddock corners (master plan).

5. **Buy from a known hatchery:** chicks come vaccinated there against Newcastle disease, Gumboro, Marek's disease, infectious bronchitis and avian influenza [V LVS-68].

The hen house, for 100 hens

Part	Size
Floor	20 m², 4 × 5 m, deep litter 10 cm of dry shavings or rice husks (5 hens per m² [V LVS-69])
Walls and roof	solid to 1 m, wire mesh above for air, a roof overhang of 0.6 m against rain
Nest boxes	20 boxes, each about 30 × 30 × 35 cm, one for every 5 hens [A]
Perches	20 m in all, 20 cm per hen, 0.6 m above the litter [A]
Feeders and drinkers	for 11 to 12 kg of feed and 17 to 24 litres of water a day [V LVS-67]
Run	a fenced run of about 100 m² beside the house, with shade [A]

The goat house, for 4 does

Part	Size
Floor	raised slatted floor about 0.8 m above the ground, 1.2 m² per doe and 0.3 m² per kid [A]: about 8 m²
Roof and walls	roofed, open on the side away from the wind, dry and well aired
Feed and water	a hay rack and a water trough; each goat eats dry matter of 2.5 to 3.5% of its weight and drinks 1.5 to 3.3 litres a day [V LVS-26, LVS-27]

Every day, every week

When	Hens	Goats
Morning	feed, fresh water, collect the eggs, look for a sick bird	let out to the paddock, water, look at the eyes, coat and droppings
Evening	collect the eggs again, close the house	bring in, hay, water, close the house

When	Hens	Goats
Every week	top up or change the litter, weigh the feed used, count the eggs	clean the slats, check the hooves
As the vet says	Newcastle boosters	PPR vaccination; deworming, since worms kill most goats [V LVS-14, LVS-10]

Money

Item	Price	Source
Layer feed	above RWF 700 a kg	[V LVS-70]
Eggs in Bugesera	RWF 150 farm-gate, 200 retail, each	[V MKT-60]
A tray of eggs	about RWF 4,300 farm-gate	[V LVS-71]
A local goat	about RWF 40,000 for a medium goat in Bugesera (2022); improved adults about 71,500 to 74,000 in Karenge (2026)	[V LVS-01, MKT-60]

What 100 hens give [E]: at 80% lay, about 80 eggs a day: the galley's 20 to 30, and two trays a day to sell. Feed costs about RWF 8,000 a day, so the margin rests on the price the farm gets for its eggs.

Selling

1. Eggs go to the galley first and the surplus to the guests and Kigali buyers; no licence was found for selling eggs.
2. Goats are sold live: selling meat needs a RICA slaughter licence, a registered premise and a registered carrier [V REG-03, REG-06].
3. Meat served in the galley comes from a licensed slaughterhouse.
4. Insure the hens with the national agricultural insurance scheme (it covers poultry, not goats) [V MKT-21].

Done when

1. The keeper is registered, the 200 m and 20 m distances are measured, and a vet is named.
2. The hen house is built to the sizes above and the first 100 hens are in.

3. Eggs reach the galley every morning, and every egg, kilogram of feed and treatment is recorded.

Open questions

1. How far are the field and its houses from the lake's flood line?
2. Who keeps the animals every day, and who covers their day off?
3. Has the district lifted the Rift Valley fever measures in writing?